

players that we've seen. File types supported are MP3 and WMA. Connecting the player to a PC for downloading music is very simple—plug it in using the USB connector that's provided and then use the bundled M-any Loader 3.4 software to drag and drop songs into the device. Please note that the device needs to be connected before the PC is switched on, otherwise a 'No device found' message is flashed.

**Price:** Rs 6,999  
**Contact:** Moon Computer Manufacturing Industry  
**Phone:** 022-2653390  
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**E-mail:** sales@moonindia.com  
**Web site:** www.moonindia.com

One thing that is conspicuous by its absence is the LCD display indicator, making it impossible to see the track's ID3 information. This player is best suited for those of you who want to port their MP3 tracks to their cassette players and for those who need to record minutes of their meetings on the fly.

#### SPECIFICATIONS

64 MB, weighs 70 grams, one MMC slot, USB interface, Ni-MH rechargeable battery

| M-any DAH200    |           | B+ |
|-----------------|-----------|----|
|                 |           |    |
| Performance     | ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ |    |
| Build quality   | ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ |    |
| Value for money | ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ |    |
| Features        | ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ |    |
| <b>OVERALL</b>  | ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ |    |

## Creative Sound Blaster Extigy

World of audio

It might be difficult to find another device packed with the features and sophistication of Extigy. It plugs into



the USB port of the PC and takes over the sound functions; you don't need to install an internal soundcard. If you already have one, the Extigy will simply override it. The Extigy has all major controls upfront for easy access. It can also work without the PC

and can take input from a DVD player, MD player, portable MP3 player and even gaming consoles such as the PlayStation2 and Xbox. It can also create 'pseudo' surround modes from two-channel stereo music or games for use with 5.1, four and even two-speaker setups.

The software bundled with the Extigy has applications to organise music playlists for playback and recording, as well as for audio processing such as cleaning up clicks and pops and adding reverb. However, the Extigy does not have an in-built amplifier and must be used with amplified speakers like Creative's own Inspire 5300 and 5700, or with an external power amplifier.

#### SPECIFICATIONS

5.1 channel support, Dolby Digital compliant

| Creative Sound Blaster Extigy |           | A- |
|-------------------------------|-----------|----|
|                               |           |    |
| Performance                   | ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ |    |
| Ease of use                   | ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ |    |
| Value for money               | ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ |    |
| Features                      | ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ |    |
| <b>OVERALL</b>                | ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ |    |

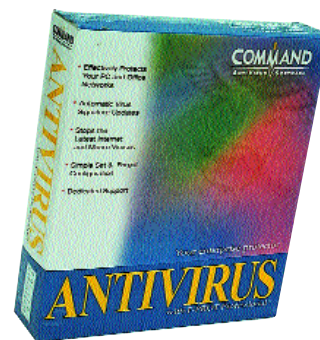
**Price:** Rs 13,650  
**Contact:** Compuage Infocom  
**Phone:** 022-8305500  
**E-mail:** info@compuageindia.com  
**Web site:** www.compuageindia.com

## Command Antivirus

Your PC's guard

Here's a no frills anti-virus software, which is light on your system and is yet an extremely fast and effective virus scanner. It has a strong F-PROT-based engine capable of detecting viruses and curing, renaming, quarantining or deleting files in real time or through on-demand scanning. If you are a network administrator you will definitely appreciate its ability to send custom messages via e-mail, containing a short warning or the full scan report. This can be helpful if you manage virus protection on a range of machines.

On the whole, this is an anti-virus software with good



detection rates and is backed by an excellent technical support team, ensuring that your system remains virus free.

#### SPECIFICATIONS

Windows 95/98/Me/2000/XP, 5 MB install size

| Command Antivirus |           | B |
|-------------------|-----------|---|
|                   |           |   |
| Performance       | ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ |   |
| Ease of use       | ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ |   |
| Value for money   | ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ |   |
| Features          | ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ |   |
| <b>OVERALL</b>    | ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ |   |

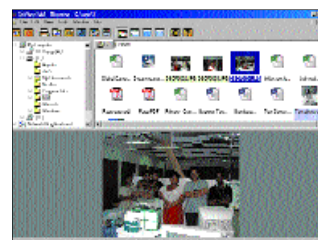
**Price:** Rs 1,500  
**Contact:** Command Software Systems  
**Phone:** 022-5006650  
**Fax:** 022-5006651  
**E-mail:** info@commandindia.com

## Xnview

App with a view

Xnview is an image viewer and a multimedia player that supports more than 340 file formats, including PNG, JPEG, Targa, TIFF, GIF, BMP, animated GIF, multipage TIFF, MPEG, AVI, WAV, AIFF and QuickTime files. All files are displayed as thumbnails in its Explorer-like viewer; to get a full view, simply point the cursor on the image. It also creates slideshows and all files can be converted into any selected file format through a batch conversion process. This feature is quite handy if you need to convert images in different formats to a single format for prepress printing or processing. You can also use this application to create contact sheets—this makes it easier to glance

through a set of thumbnails as they are on a single sheet. Xnview supports OSes ranging from the legacy DOS and Windows 3.x to Windows XP, Linux, AIX and Sun Solaris.



One interesting feature is that you can change the language used, on the fly, which changes the menu commands. But be careful, a mistake here could make the application completely unusable. To undo this, we had to